

## THE MOVE

**Acknowledge the friction:** "I hear that the current version doesn't work." -> **Ask for workable conditions:** "What would make it workable?" -> **Protect autonomy:** "And if it's not workable at all, that's useful to know too." -> **Agree the next small step: ?**

## START HERE

Validate the friction, then ask one question: "Got it. What would make this workable, if anything?" — and stay quiet while they think.

## SAY THIS

|                     |                                                                                  |
|---------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Quick openers       | "What would make this workable, if anything?"                                    |
| Warm & validating   | "I hear that this version doesn't work. What would?"                             |
| Work & planning     | "What would need to change for this to be realistic on your side?"               |
| Clarify & narrow    | "Which part is least workable: timing, scope, risk, or something else?"          |
| Boundary & autonomy | "If the answer is no, I'll respect that. Is there any version that would work?"  |
| Under pressure      | "Before we force a decision, what would make this practical enough to consider?" |

## AVOID

- The person has given a clear final no or asked to stop discussing it.
- Safety, legal, consent, privacy, or ethical boundaries are at stake.
- You hold power over the person and the question could land as pressure.

## REMEMBER

**Ask once, then actually listen.**